CVScholar Retention Diagnosis and Activation Plan

Date: 2026-05-06

Data window: 2026-01-01 to 2026-05-06

Data source: Analytics API export (users, events, behavior, sessions, funnel)

Admin account excluded from behavior conclusions.

Executive Summary

- Users are starting CV creation, but many do not reach first successful compile.
- The biggest conversion leak is from editor usage to compile completion.
- Technical reliability issues (editor JavaScript errors) directly hurt trust and completion.
- Return behavior is weak after day 1, so lifecycle nudges are required.

Key Findings

- Total non-admin users analyzed: 43
- Users with at least 1 CV: 35 (81.4%)
- Users who viewed editor paths (/cv/edit/*): 18
- Users with pdf_compiled event: 4
- Editor to compile conversion: 22.2%
- Returned after day 1: 4 / 43 (9.3%)
- Never returned after day 1: 39 / 43

Friction Signals

- js_error events: 32
- Main js_error message: Unexpected token '.' in editor.js
- rage_click events: 163
- form_abandon events: 308

Non-Compiler Segment (High Risk)

- Users who touched editor but never compiled: 14
- In this segment:
- js_error events: 32
- rage_click events: 157
- form_abandon events: 157
- compile button clicks: 46

Root Cause Hypotheses

- Reliability regressions in editor break user trust and block core actions.
- New users can create CV records, but completion guidance to first compile is weak.
- Editor complexity causes cognitive overload for first-time users.
- No rapid recovery flow exists when frustration signals are detected.
- No strong return loop after signup and first draft activity.

Phase-Wise Plan

Phase 1: Stabilize Core Reliability (Week 1)

Goal: Remove technical blockers that prevent Add Entry and Compile.

Actions:

- Add automated production check for critical editor script integrity.
- Alert on js_error spikes for /cv/edit/* with path and message grouping.
- Keep versioned JS asset loading enabled to avoid stale CDN files.
- Add fast rollback runbook for editor JavaScript incidents.

Expected outcomes:
- 70%+ reduction in js_error on editor paths.
- 40%+ reduction in rage_click tied to compile and entry actions.

Phase 2: First-Compile Guided UX (Week 2)

Goal: Improve edit-to-compile conversion for first-time users.

Actions:
- Show a persistent next-step panel after first entry save: Compile your first PDF.
- Keep Compile button sticky and visible while editing.
- Add a compile progress state and clear success confirmation.
- After success, show Download CTA and What to do next guidance.

Expected outcomes:
- Edit-to-compile conversion from 22.2% to at least 35%.
- 20%+ increase in pdf_downloaded after first compile.

Phase 3: Friction Rescue and Recovery (Week 3)

Goal: Intervene during failure or confusion moments.

Actions:
- Trigger contextual help when user hits rage_click threshold.
- If compile fails twice, show one-click support prompt and troubleshooting hints.
- Add inline hints for most abandoned editor sections.

Expected outcomes:
- 30% reduction in form_abandon on top editor paths.
- 25% reduction in repeated failed compile attempts per session.

Phase 4: Day-1 and Day-3 Lifecycle Re-Engagement (Week 4)

Goal: Increase return rate and first compile completion after initial session.

Actions:
- Day-1 email for users with cv_created but no pdf_compiled.
- Day-3 follow-up with direct deep link to resume editor.
- Dashboard banner: Finish and Compile your first CV.

Expected outcomes:
- Day-1+ return rate from 9.3% to at least 18%.
- Additional 10-15% of non-compilers converted within 7 days.

KPI Dashboard (Track Weekly)

- Editor js_error rate per 100 editor page_views
- Rage click rate on /cv/edit/*
- Form abandon rate on /cv/edit/*
- Edit-to-compile conversion

- Compile-to-download conversion
- Day-1 return rate
- 7-day activation rate (registered to first pdf_compiled)

Implementation Priority

- Reliability fixes and monitoring (highest impact, immediate)
- First compile guided journey
- Friction rescue triggers
- Lifecycle re-engagement automation

Notes

- The recent editor syntax bug materially affected behavior signals.
- Re-measure this same dashboard for 14 days after Phase 1 to separate technical recovery from UX uplift.